

(I've Had) The Time of My Life (Rhythm Guitar) -- Bill Medley & Jennifer Warnes

From the *Dirty Dancing* soundtrack (1987). About 108 BPM once the groove kicks in, est.

A slow, free-time intro, then a bright late-80s pop-soul groove that builds to the famous key-change finale.

The record is keys, sax, and vocals first. The guitar job is clean, chorused, funky 80s rhythm, plus a driven lead voice for the fills and the big ending.

Built from the song's overall sound. I haven't verified the exact guitars and amps on the record.

Instrument: Stratocaster (HSS). Position 2 or 4 for the funky rhythm. Bridge humbucker for the lead.

GP-5 only, Stratocaster (HSS), no pedalboard.

AMP: J-120 CL (Jazz Chorus) + CAB: EVM112 IR (User IR 5)

A Roland JC is the definitive 80s studio clean: pristine, glassy, and built to pair with chorus.

EVM112 is the loaded guitar cab with a flat, hi-fi response. It keeps Nashville clean tones honest and doesn't add V30 honk.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 16.

Keeps the 16th-note muted scratching clean.

PRE -- COMP (Ross), always on.

Sustain: 40, VOL: 55.

80s funk rhythm is squashed. Sustain 40 gives even, percussive chucks.

DST -- Super OD (SD-1), on CTL.

Gain: 45, Tone: 58, VOL: 70.

The lead voice. An SD-1 into a clean JC gives a smooth, slightly compressed 80s lead. VOL 70 lifts it over the sax and keys.

AMP -- J-120 CL, always on.

VOL: 60, Bass: 45, Middle: 50, Treble: 58, Bright: off.

Pristine clean. Treble 58 for sparkle, Bright off to avoid ice.

CAB -- User IR 5 (EVM112), always on.

VOL: 60.

EQ -- Guitar EQ 2, always on.

100Hz: -3, 500Hz: -1, 1kHz: 0, 3kHz: +2, 6kHz: 0, VOL: 50.

The low cut and 500Hz dip clear space for the keys. +2 at 3kHz for chuck.

MOD -- A-Chorus, always on.

Depth: 30, Rate: 0.8, Tone: 55.

Depth 30 is heavier than my usual light hand. This is one of the songs where an obvious 80s chorus is part of the sound.

DLY -- Analog, on CTL.

Mix: 18, Time: 420ms, F.Back: 25, Trail: on.

About three-sixteenths at 108 BPM. It fattens the lead.

RVB -- Plate, always on.

Mix: 18, Decay: 40, Damp: 45, Trail: on.

An 80s-style plate for polish.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: DST (Super OD), DLY (Analog).

- **CTL off** -- Rhythm. Chorused, compressed JC clean for the funky chucking and the intro swells. This is the resting state the patch loads into.
- **CTL on** -- Lead. SD-1 plus analog delay for the fills and the key-change finale.

Engage CTL for fills and the final chorus lift. Stay off for the rhythm grooves.